conflict of interests and clashes, the liberals lay emphasis on the common interests. The belief is that people and nations share common interests and the prospects of cooperative activities among them will satisfy these interests. Liberals are critical about the realist perspective of international conflict and war and consider them as a distortion of reality. On the other hand, they believe that on the whole the majority of interactions among nations are cooperative and non-conflictual. Wars do take place but they contend that the majority of nations live in peace and the fact that they are at peace is not because of any balance of power.

Most importantly, the liberal contention for human progress is worth mentioning. At the core of this thinking is also the implicit trust (or liberal faith) that human beings by nature are rational creatures. The liberals reject the realist position that the basic dynamics and fundamental realities of international relations remain unchanged. They contend that as people are rational, they would learn that certain things such as war is irrational and undesirable and, as they learn more about how the world they live in works they will gain knowledge which ultimately will help them to solve problems. As Robert Gilpin (*War and Change in World Politics*, 1981) noted that, just as realism “is founded on a pessimism regarding moral progress and human possibilities”, so too liberalism is founded on an optimism regarding moral progress and human possibilities.

Kegley and Wittkopf[3] present the underlying beliefs of the liberalist worldview and uphold that the basic assumptions of liberalism are:

1. Human nature is essentially “good” or altruistic and people are, therefore, capable of mutual aid and collaboration.
2. The fundamental human concern for others’ welfare makes progress possible.
3. Bad human behaviour, such as violence, is the product not of flawed people but of evil institutions which encourage people to act selfishly and to harm others.
4. War is not inevitable and its frequency can be reduced by eradicating the institutional arrangements that encourage it.
5. War is an international problem requiring collective or multilateral, rather than national, efforts to control it.